

DUNCAN FLAMETORN (MATT) *Human Swordmage*

I slayed the Pirate Captain Crookshanks. When I wrenched my sword from its lifeless corpse, the flame on my sword was blue.

Icons +1 Lightning Witch
+1 Varda, Star Kindler
-1 Gûlrymsúl

Backgrounds

- Youngest Defender to learn Sigil Mastery at Academy in the Northern Tower.
- Defeated Obran to win the Defender's Gauntlet in the recent summer games on The Isle of Champions.
- With Ragnus & Estrid, discovered 'The Floating Plateau' while editing the Lightning Witch's 27th Quinquagenary Map of All Known Threats to the Midland Sea.
- *safeguard Eärendur's soul & rebuild Mariners, find Eärendur's soul stone in Tomb of the Gods*

GRAVEL (SEAN) *Stonehearted Knight*

(forgeborn) Sorcerer

I'm the only Stonehearted Knight to attain the rank of officer.

Icons ~1 King Battlehammer ~1 Orome the Huntsman
-1 Divine Emperox Xinyǎng -1 Gûlrymsúl

Backgrounds

- Initiated into the Flaming Fists, a secret officers' fraternity, while attending King Battlehammer's Officer Candidate School.
- Creator of the rare blue jade necklace, under the tutelage of Hammer, leader of the Forgemasters, who enchanted them.
- *find staff's origin, forge Eärendur's construct, liberate Stonehearted Knights*

MALTHAEL (TANDY) *High elf Bladesinger*

When near their graves, I hear prayers for the dead.

Icons +2 Varda, Star Kindler
-1 Gûlrymsúl -1 Wraith Lord

Backgrounds

- As a Special Negotiator for The Blades, convinced and supported the people of the Wake Islands to overthrow the necromancer splinter cell 'Cursed Wraiths'.
- Endured The Trials (Blades qualification), earning the longest survival time in the Three Realms of the Elves and the Blade-singers Mythquest before returning to the Court of the Stars.
- *hear dead gods and Divine Emperox, restore Great Tree*

ORAMIR THE SEER (HANS) *Speaker (Holy One Cleric)*

My right eye was blinded when I was touched by the bright gods. Now that eye sees visions of the gods' realm.

Icons +1 Divine Emperox Xinyǎng
+1 Orn the Misbegotten ~1 Varda, Star Kindler
-1 Gûlrymsúl

Backgrounds

- Successfully defended Guanyin's Kruko Temple in Glitterhagen from a Cursed Merchant attack on the 1,000th year festival
- Compelled confession from David Fillion, the Halos' bookkeeper, for Divine Emperox
- *speak for the gods, find the way via Deep Bridge to Tomb of the Gods*

STINK (CHRIS) *Goblin Ranger*

Somewhere in a forgotten sub-basement of the Emperox's Cathedral is a dusty, cobwebbed, all-but-ignored little shrine to Stink.

Icons -2 Gûlrymsúl
+1 the Silver Master +1 Varda, Star Kindler

Backgrounds

- Escaped from Daevos the Cursed Merchant's goblin horde to sanctuary on the kitchen staff of the Silver Grotto.
- As a deacon in the Cult of the Mad Potato God (a minor cult in the reformed branch of the goblin religion), served in the Victorious Worship on the 1st of Jubilation.
- *restore the Great Tree, ascend to heaven again*

ASTROTH (AARON) *Demontouched Sorcerer*

Knows demons aren't defeated because his veins carry demon blood.

Icons +2 Lightning Witch ~1 Varda, Starkindler
-1 Silver Master

Backgrounds

- Middling student at Wizard Academy
- Lightning Witch training group was massacred by elder windigo at Starport
- *free demons to attack devils*

VALOR IS THE CENTER OF EVERYTHING

DEVILS: Kill gods, including the White CURSED SKULL: raise undead

small gods, as a start VALOR: what was awakened / freed/ broken by summoning

The Godkillers have breached the Last Bastion of Heavenly Light. Betrayed by an angel. It is becoming a prison, or a slaughterhouse, for the last beleaguered gods of light, unless the heroes can evacuate them to Valor.

OUTER HEAVEN BONUS

- **Gravel:** staff points “home,” Heaven’s Gate; Overworld Advantage: Daily = recharge 16+
- **Stink:** all are vulnerable to Stink, can summon Flower
- **Astaroth:** Overworld Advantage: Dailies are recharge 16+
- **Duncan:** Eärendur speaks
- **Mal:** hears the Divine Emperox’s prayers
- **Oramir:** sees heaven’s view of world
- [Character summary](#)

CAST OF HEAVEN

Flower...Uqaviel, the Shard of Moonlight, Flower of the Mad Potato

Anahita reigns over a blinded heavens

Guanyin: god of light - frail but self-sacrificing, first among equals

Dàmén: the gate of heaven, a divine being - a tall, slender figure, robed in starlight circled with (vertical) halos of light like windows into another place

Jǐngwèi: the guard of heaven’s gate - giant angelic being (without wings), wields a gigantic sword flaming with starlight

Gān, captain of the angelic guard - bright golden armor, dark radiant skin, golden spear

Godhammer: Godkillers’ captain - a hulking dwarf with great batlike wings and a hammer wreathed in red flame, glowing and sputtering

ICONS’ INTERESTS

- **Gulrymsul** wants to destroy the gods, and with them the Great Tree, and be free.
- **Varda Starkindler** wants to stop Gulrymsul. She’s a heavenly being allied with Jingwei, the guard of Heaven’s Gate. Varda gave him his sword. There is another, its twin, that she wants rescued. (Need for Elven Towers.)
- **The Lightning Witch** wants to find the Valley of the Gods, where gods are buried, so she can transform. She found god—Guanyin—and repented of dealing with devils (Floating Plateau), but it cost her.
- **The Divine Emperox** desperately needs to hear from the gods, who have been silent, to avoid temptation to apostasy. In the meantime, she’s withdrawn herself and her leadership; her lieutenants are running the empire.
- **The Silver Master** seeks union with the elven ancestors, specifically Eärendur. Though imprisoned by Orome, he’s exactly where he wants to be.
- **King Battlehammer** lost himself and is enthralled to Gulrymsul, unkempt and bent over a corrupted pool. His Godkillers seek to do Gulrymsul’s will.
- **Orome the Huntsman** is desperate for legitimacy. He wants the blessing of the Great Tree and the elven ancestors. He chafes in allegiance to King Battlehammer because he has not received this.
- **Wraith Lord** wants to raise a god-lich and seeks the Valley of the Gods.
- **Orn the Misbegotten** wants a truer, more inclusive imperial pantheon.

SCENE 0: LEVEL UP TO 7

Suddenly inside an iridescent bubble, color shimmers, swirls, then pops.

You feel ministered to by the very presence of Guanyin. [Full heal up.]

What's a problem in Valor that's nagging at you?

[Dominion](#)

SCENE 1.1: EMERGING AS GODHAMMER CAPTURES GATE OF HEAVEN

- Establish breathtaking grandeur, beleaguered nature, and battle, which is ending in defeat.
- Show Godhammer leaping away with Dàmén in tow.
- Introduce Gān as dutiful, selfless, compliant

You emerge from a pool, surrounded by rock and dust. There is a black void all around, like the night sky but blacker. All manner of galaxies, planets, moons all up close orbit slowly in the "sky." More than one moon is shattered. The largest planet is shattered, it's molten core's glow visible through the cracks and new debris field. From the whole half, a bridge made of starlight and lensflare stretches into the distance. At the end of this bridge, a bright light. But it flickers, like a bulb on the fritz.

Oramir: you see the world—your world, not a black void, like a fish eye lense, obscured now and then by those heavenly bodies

Ma!: utter silence, then whalebone god

Challenge: pulling fallen angel off prone Guanyin, evading attacks

As you pull yourself to the edges of the pool, you see figures glow with an inner light. They are angels with wings of starlight, fighting, dying. Many lay wounded and maimed.

Scene 1.2: Short, Hard Fight

You see Godhammer deal a crushing blow to Jǐngwèi (kneeling), then grab Dàmén, and leap into the sky. Many fallen angels follow him, their wings stained the color of rust. Gān cradles Jǐngwèi's head.

Gān comes to someone's aid...

SCENE 1.3: SITUATION BRIEFING AND MISSION PLANNING

- Guanyin blames herself. Jǐngwèi is wounded grievously (left kidney) and weeping. Guanyin partially heals Jǐngwèi. They talk, naming Godkillers captain, Godhammer, and identifying Fallen Sphere (shattered planet, formerly the gatehouse of heaven, burning core exposed, portal to hell?)
- Heaven has a mole. Jǐngwèi was—claims to be—stabbed in the back, before the assault began.
- Establish Jǐngwèi as loveable and open to learn if rigidly righteous and quick to judge, also wounded. "I just guard the Gate."
- Gān's intel: "They can smell us. You, they cannot smell." Well guarded, go around, underground

Astroth: Jǐngwèi grabs him by the scruff of the neck and eyes him hard. "Are you a spy? What's wrong with this one?"

Duncan: flame envelopes body, thin veneer: elf ears, a crown, a distinguishing sign of Eärendur

Stink: Gān bows to you and gestures to empty sky, "We have preserved your throne, blessed one." Jǐngwèi, strained: "But we expelled that traitor, the Shard of Moonlight."

SCENE 1.4: TRAVEL TO FALLEN SPHERE, ARDA

- Guanyin goes secretly to create a pool at Valor, a flare of light: a falling star, falling upward
- Flower talks about how the sky and spheres once were. Gets nervous about drawing their attention. "They can smell me. You, they cannot smell."

How do they get there?

SCENE 1.5: DUNGEON CRAWL INSIDE THE SPHERE

- Fight: Purple worm nest
- Feeding on the body of a dead god, decomposing into a multicolored geode like soul incubator thing

SCENE 1.6: THE MOLTEN HEART OF THE SPHERE

Great metal-on-metal screeching noises guide you. Top of great cliff, wide chasm. Far to left, a bridge down. Dàmén is suspended on chains. Fallen angels turn great winches/capstans. Chains with great hooks prize open his halos. Godhammer stands before Dàmén, yelling commands over his shoulder, "Harder!" Through the halos you see a pearly white boulevard, strewn with debris and a make-shift barricade. Beyond, a tower of starlight.

- Fight, Efreet (B93) and Fallen Angels (coatl B52)
- Fight, attacked by Gān and co, as Godhammer enters followed by...troops?
- Fight, the grunts turning the winches.

SCENE 1.7: RETURN TO VALOR, PURSUIT?

Guanyin waits with a calmer (but still seething) Flower.

The pool in Valor is deep below the Monastery.

The heroes were absent from Valor for 1d6+2 months

SCENE 2.1: ASSEMBLE EVACUATION TEAM

SCENE 2.2 ENTER THE GATE OF HEAVEN

Split up? Told where to look: 4 locations in heaven. Given a very small job.

- Heaven's Mere: large reflective pool surrounded by a wood)
- Deephome, within which is the Forge of Heaven
- Tower of Starlight, or Souls' Rest: damaged? Breached as souls were torn out to be chum waters
- Garden of Consolation: where gifts for the faithful on earth are grown

SCENE 2.3 LOCATE THE GODS

Scene 8: Evacuate

[Translate](#)

"Speak, O gracious gods! I have endured much. This burden of temptation rends my heart so I cannot even govern the people you entrusted to me. But no burden is heavier than your silence! Have you abandoned us? Do you mock me? I need to hear you! I am at the breaking point. I can bear this emptiness no longer. I'm falling... I'm falling..."

GĀN, CAPTAIN OF THE ANGELIC GUARD (6)

Double-strength, 11th level spoiler [celestial]

Initiative: +17

Swift Golden Spear +16 vs. AC—140 damage

Natural even hit: Gān may pop free, move, and attack a second target with a *Swift Golden Spear* attack.

C: Radiant Wings +15 vs. MD (1d3 nearby or far away enemies in a group)—90 psychic damage

Natural 18+: The target gains the *Fear* condition: -4 to attacks and loses escalation die.

BEFORE INITIATIVE IS ROLLED

Blaze of Glory: Gān fills all nearby and faraway space with the light of a sun, burning away a significant but nondangerous portion of nonliving/nonclothing material. Gān also produces 10 Glories of Gān, which start the battle engaged with Gān's enemies.

DURING BATTLE

Flight: Gān flies on wings of starlight.

Swift Golden Spear: Enemies who move to engage Gān must roll a DC 25 Dexterity-based background check. On a failure, the enemy must choose: fail to engage or engage but Gān makes an opportunity attack. Otherwise, no effect.

Refuge of starlight: When Gān fails a save, they become a creature of living starlight until the end of its next turn. While made of living starlight, Gān gains *resist damage 16+* to all attacks against AC and PD. If they're flying when they become living starlight, their magic allows them to remain in the air if they wish.

Monologuer: Gān is arrogant and prone to divulging secrets they believe their enemies will have no opportunity to act on.

WHEN GĀN'S HP IS REDUCED BELOW 150 (ONCE PER CAMPAIGN)

Glorious Rage: Gān fills all nearby and faraway space with the light of a sun. All enemies are *stuck* and those engaged with Gān take 25 fire damage and pop free. Gān becomes a creature of living starlight and takes flight. He makes two move actions and gains a +4 bonus to all defenses.

AC 27

PD 25

MD 21

HP 576

GLORY OF GĀN (0.2)

8th level mook

Initiative +11

Bright Stab +11 vs PD—25 damage, or 0 damage and the target pops free of Gān

R: Disorienting Glare +11 v MD—5 ongoing psychic damage (save ends, must roll for each 5 ongoing damage) and the target is *Vulnerable* (save ends, difficulty based on amount of ongoing damage the target is currently taking: 0--easy, 5--normal, 10--hard, 15+--a save cannot end the *Vulnerable* condition)

Resist weapon damage 16+

Mindless: Flares of Gān are immune to all attacks versus MD.

AC 23

PD 23

MD XX

HP 25

BATTLE EVENTS/MONOLOGUES

- o. *Gān reaches for the Gate, but Gravel's staff shields him / Growl of surprise and anger. Do you even know what you carry, metal mortal!? A gift of heaven! The heart of a star! It's not meant to be wielded but to be communed with! I will mend it, after I break you.*
1. *Mal hears/parrots the Divine Emperox's desperate prayers, pleading against the silence of the gods. Oramir sees her on her knees in a dark, empty Santa Cora cathedral. She's wearing her clerical vestments. / Laughs. "Your leaders are weak! You mortals succumbed so easily. Especially your dwarf king. He fell first of all. After all I gave to help Guanyin imprison G! Ruined by your weakness!"*
2. *Trumpets. Light and fallen angels streak toward each other overhead. / Too little, too late. "The necromancer will open a new portal. A master of what you call the Deep Bridge...or called...you have forgotten it. He found it, on his way to the Valley of the Gods."*
3. *Guanyin arrives. Starts a portal ritual. / "This is about justice. Consequences for mortal folly. And for the divine mercy that enables it."*
4. *Stars start going dark. /*
5. *Anahita arrives. Angels fall. /*

MORE GOD STUFF

Ainu Nuru-athae (god of [death](#), [healing](#)), servant of Eru Éil-isil-lórë, patron of the Silver Master - holding a vigil of sorts for Eru Éil-isil-lórë, who is missing

Ainu Éil-isil-lórë (god of [stars](#), [moon](#), [dreams](#)), patron of Varda Starkindler and the Children of the White - is she Varda?

Ilúamillë - All-Mother, creator god, Guanyin

Valar - 14 gods who entered the world, surrendering power and glory to do so, Gulrymsul's prison-wardens and the crafter of his prison

Maia - servants of the Valar who took mortal form

- **Ulmo**, water god -
- **Manwë**, wind god -
- **Aulë**, god of crafting and smithing - creator of dwarves, spouse of Yavanna
- **Arum** the Great Rider - steed Nahar
 - Oromë, huntsman of the gods - terrible wrath
- **Mandos**, judge of the dead, keeper of souls - chief advisor to Manwë, husband of Vairë
 - the Silver Master
- **Lórien**, dream god -
- **Astaldo**, god of strength - last of Valar to descend, tipped the scales
 - Stink -
- **Elentári**, goddess of stars
 - Varda
- **Nienna**, goddess of mercy and endurance in hope
- **Estë**, goddess of healing and rest
- **Vairë** the Weaver, goddess of memory and history - architect of Gulrymsul's prison and his divine first victim
- **Yavanna**, goddess of fruit, plants, and trees - spouse of Aulë
- **Vána**, goddess of youth and blossoming flowers - younger sister of Yavanna, wife of Oromë
- **Nessa** the Dancer - wife of Tulkas, sister of Oromë

The Deeps of Time

Seven deadly sins - wrath (Orome),

Kowal Relationship Axes

- Mind: comparable intelligence
- Money: what money is for, money goals, not same amount
- Morals: what is right and wrong in the world
- Manners: same idea of what is polite and not
- Monogamy: same idea of the relationship
- The Marx Brothers: laugh at the same things

Two Scales of Power: position vs personal power

Iconic vs Epic, Static vs Arc of Change

Backstory tips, suggest long relationship: in jokes ("You mean that time with the pumpkin?"), reactions to each other like eye rolls, less is more

Mice Quotient

Character dissatisfied with aspect of self: I am alone. External vs internal conflict in relationship, relationship problem vs problem that impacts the relationship... Blowing it up vs keeping it together.

A marriage of enemies, with enemies of the marriage.

A grandfather awakened from the dead by a greedy, ambitious grandson who wishes to depose his brother.

Town falsely sworn in fealty to a lord and his knight but truly in league with the brigand enemies of the lord.

A knight and his pompous but cowardly squire meets a young but eager and brave boy.

A man in love with a fickle and dangerous but hungry for love fey queen.

stonehearted knight in
fallen soldier's soul
magical - a can

Guanyin myth
star crossed lovers
as they walk

the Repose of C
Astame the Wise
in the last living
the tree with his
Graces are Gulryon
off Oraniv &

raw myth, unfiltered
quicksilver staff